

Izzy Escobar — 2.0 “Deep Think” FOH EQ

Fountain Square (outdoor) · DiGiCo Quantum 225 · 2026-06-24 · Research-backed pass over Rev 2.0

Who she is & why it drives the EQ. Izzy Escobar is a Cuban-Italian pop-soul / indie-R&B singer-songwriter (debut EP *Sunny in London*, 2025). Classically trained on violin, piano-forward writing, lush but *restrained* production — reviewers call it grit-grace-and-soul over maximalism. Her voice is the show: an Amy-Winehouse throaty grit blended with Adele-style soulful power. That means the mix philosophy here is **not** the house aggressive default — it leans musical and subtractive, protecting warmth and the vocal's chest/low-mid body. **Working against that:** Fountain Square is open-air — no room gain, low end dissipates, HF falls off over distance, and there's slap off the surrounding facades but no reverb tail to hide behind. So a touch more low-end support and vocal presence than a studio-soul mix, while keeping the restraint. Every move below is built from mic behavior × instrument × genre × the open-air room.

What changed from Rev 2.0 — and why

- **Izzy vox (Ch25):** killed the static -5 @8k and replaced with a *dynamic* de-ess; HPF 130→110. The KMS 105 isn't sibilant and has a smooth 7-12k presence — a soul voice wants that air, and her throaty body lives low. Don't shelf the sound away.
- **Acoustic (Ch15):** moved the air boost off 5k. Research is clear that -5k is the brassy *piezo harshness* zone you cut, not boost — air now sits at 8k, the -6 @2k still kills the quack.
- **Guitar 27 (Ch14):** stopped doubling the SM57's 2.5k. Beta 27's job is the airy top (8-9k) and clean low body the 57 lacks — let it own those, 57 owns mids.
- **Self-present mics eased (i5, D2, SM81 OH):** these capsules already bring their own presence/scoop, so the big +5 boosts were pulled back — trust the mic, push less.
- **Tracks (Ch20):** left near-flat. It's a mastered, full-range stem — EQ'ing it like a mic'd source thins her lush bed.

DRUMS

Ch 1 | Kick In · Shure Beta 91A

HPF 40 | LPF off || B4 +4 @3k Q1.2 B3 -2 @600 Q2.0 B2 -3 @250 Q1.8 B1 +3 @80 Q1.2

The 91A is the **attack engine** — boundary mic inside the drum, it owns beater click and top. +4 @3k gives definition that travels outdoors (eased from +5; pop-soul kick wants punch, not a metal click). Lows kept modest (+3 @80) so they don't stack with the 52A — let the 52A own the weight. 250 box cut eased to -3 because open-air has far less low-mid buildup than a room.

Ch 2 | Kick Out · Shure Beta 52A

HPF 40 | LPF off || B4 +3 @3k Q1.2 B3 -2 @600 Q2.0 B2 -3 @250 Q1.8 B1 +5 @80 Q1.2

The 52A is the **body/punch engine**. +5 @80 supports the weight the open air swallows. Just a hair of 3k for snap; the 91A carries the real click. Mud cut eased for the same outdoor reason.

BLEND: treat the pair as ONE — same VCA, pan together, blend constant. Polarity: sum in mono, flip ∅ on one mic if thinner than either alone. Bus: notch -2/-3 dB @300-500 if the low-mids stack.

Ch 3 | Snare Top · Audix i5

HPF 120 | LPF off || B4 +2 @7k Q0.8 B3 -2 @5.5k Q2.0 B2 +3 @1k Q1.0 B1 -5 @300 Q2.0

The i5 already has a built-in ~3.5k presence peak and a scooped midrange, with more body and *less* boxiness than an SM57. So the crack boost is small (+3 @1k, eased from +4) and the box cut is -5 not -7 — the capsule isn't boxy, don't gut it. +2 @7k for top snap to cut outdoors; optional -2 @5.5k tames ring.

Ch 5 | *Hat* · Shure SM81

HPF 500 | LPF 16k || B4 flat B3 flat B2 -5 @2k Q1.2 B1 -6 @800 Q1.5

SM81 gives smooth, un-hyped highs — no HF boost needed. Just clear the low bleed (800) and the 2k clang so it sparkles without harshness. Kept as-is; it was well judged.

Ch 6 | *Rack 1* · Audix D2

HPF 90 | LPF 12k || B4 flat B3 +4 @2.8k Q1.0 B2 -3 @450 Q1.8 B1 +3 @135 Q1.2

D2 is tuned to control tom resonance and is articulate with little EQ. Attack lift eased to +4 — trust the capsule. Gentle body, modest mud cut.

Ch 7 | *Rack 2* · Audix D2

HPF 80 | LPF 12k || B4 flat B3 +4 @2.5k Q1.0 B2 -3 @405 Q1.8 B1 +3 @120 Q1.2

Same logic as Rack 1, shifted down for the larger drum. Let the D2 do the work.

Ch 8 | *Floor* · Audix D4

HPF 55 | LPF 10k || B4 flat B3 +4 @1.8k Q1.0 B2 -3 @405 Q1.8 B1 +4 @70 SHELF

The D4 natively reaches an octave lower than the D2, so the body shelf stays modest (+4) — it's support, not a big lift. Ride the sub outdoors so it doesn't bloom. Attack at 1.8k for stick definition.

Ch 9 | *OH HL* · Shure SM81

HPF 180 | LPF off || B4 flat B3 flat B2 +3 @5k Q0.8 B1 -5 @300 Q1.5

Cymbal sheen boost eased from +5 to +3 — the SM81 is already detailed up top, and a big lift gets brittle over a long outdoor throw. These are the kit glue; keep them honest. 300 cut clears low wash/bleed.

Ch 10 | *OH HR* · Shure SM81

HPF 180 | LPF off || B4 flat B3 flat B2 +3 @5k Q0.8 B1 -5 @300 Q1.5

Matched to OH HL. Keep the stereo pair identical.

BASS

Ch 11 | *Bass DI* · XLR (DI)

HPF 40 | LPF off || B4 -5 @1.5k Q1.5 B3 +5 @600 Q1.0 B2 -6 @250 Q2.0 B1 +5 @80 SHELF

Soul/Motown bass = dark, round, low-mid forward, top rolled off. The DI carries the lows the mic can't. +5 @600 is the Motown low-mid 'wool'; -5 @1.5k tames string clank for that round tone; -6 @250 keeps it from stacking with kick and cab; +5 @80 shelf is the foundation.

Ch 12 | *Bass Mic* · Shure SM57

HPF 60 | LPF 5k || B4 flat B3 +5 @900 Q1.0 B2 -7 @400 Q2.0 B1 +5 @100 SHELF

The 57 rolls off below ~200, so it isn't a low-end source — it's the **punch / moving-air mid layer** over the DI. +5 @900 is its grind; -7 @400 carves a pocket so it doesn't double the DI's mud. LPF 5k keeps the dark soul character — no fizz on top.

BLEND with the DI: DI = weight + low-mid warmth, 57 = punch + air. Group to one VCA, check polarity against the DI.

GUITARS

Ch 13 | Guitar 57 · Shure SM57

HPF 100 | LPF off || B4 +4 @2.5k Q1.0 B3 +3 @800 Q1.2 B2 -5 @450 Q2.0 B1 -4 @200 Q2.0

The 57 owns the **mid grit + presence core**. For her dreamy, supportive guitar sound (not a rock wall) the mid boosts are eased — +4 @2.5k and +3 @800 so it sits under the vocal. Box cut at 450, and 200 cleared so it doesn't stack with the 27's body.

Ch 14 | Guitar 27 · Shure Beta 27

HPF 100 | LPF off || B4 +4 @9k Q0.8 B3 +1 @800 Q1.2 B2 -2 @450 Q2.0 B1 +2 @120 SHELF

Re-thought from Rev 2.0. The Beta 27 is a bright, detailed side-address condenser — its value is the *airy top and clean low body the 57 lacks*, not its midrange. So instead of doubling the 57 at 2.5k, give it air at 9k and a touch of clean body at 120, stay out of the mids. 57 owns mids, 27 owns air + body — no doubling.

Ch 15 | Acoustic Guitar · BSS AR-133 (DI, piezo)

HPF 100 | LPF off || B4 +3 @8k SHELF B3 -6 @2k Q1.8 B2 -5 @400 Q2.0 B1 +4 @200 SHELF

Biggest correction. Rev 2.0 boosted +5 at 5k — but 5k is exactly the *brassy piezo harshness* you want to cut, not lift. Air moved up to 8k where it actually helps; -6 @2k is the core piezo-quack fix; -5 @400 removes box; +4 @200 shelf adds the body piezos lack.

Optional: a DEQ (dynamic bell) ~1-3k that only bites on loud strums tames quack on attacks without gutting sustain.

KEYS, CLICK, GUIDE & TRACKS

Ch 17 | Keys · Whirlwind IMP (DI)

HPF 60 | LPF off || B4 flat B3 +4 @2.5k Q0.8 B2 +3 @300 Q0.8 B1 -5 @200 Q1.5

Piano is central to her writing, so keys get warmth (+3 @300) and a little clarity (+4 @2.5k, eased from +5) without being hyped. -5 @200 clears mud so it doesn't crowd the bass and vocal low-mids.

Ch 18 | Click · Whirlwind IMP (DI)

HPF 80 | LPF off || B2 -4 @315 Q2.0 B1 -2 @200 SHELF

Utility — mud trimmed so it's clean in the players' ears.

Confirm CLICK is MONITORS / IEM only — never assigned to the FOH mix.

Ch 19 | Guide · Whirlwind IMP (DI)

HPF 80 | LPF off || B2 -4 @315 Q2.0 B1 -2 @200 SHELF

Guide vocal/cue track — same utility treatment.

Confirm GUIDE is MONITORS / IEM only — not in FOH.

Ch 20 | Tracks · Whirlwind IMP (DI)

HPF 30 | LPF off || B2 -2 @315 Q2.0 (only if it muds) otherwise FLAT

Re-thought. Tracks is a finished, mastered full-range stem (her lush strings/synths/BGV bed) — it's already balanced. EQ'ing it like a mic'd source thins the production. Leave it near-flat; only a small 315 trim if it clouds the band live.

LEAD VOCAL

Ch 25 | Izzy · Neumann KMS 105

HPF 110 | LPF 15k || B4 DEQ de-ess -3 @7.5k Q3 (peaks only) B3 -3 @1.6k Q1.4 B2 -4 @300 Q2.0 B1 flat (or -1 @200)

The show lives here. The KMS 105 is transparent with a smooth 7-12k presence and is *not* a sibilant mic — so a static -5 @8k throws away the air a soul voice wants. Replaced with a **dynamic** de-ess that only acts on sibilant peaks. HPF pulled to 110 (mic compensates proximity internally, won't boom) to protect the throaty Winehouse chest body that *is* her sound — don't shelf the low away. -3 @1.6k is gentle nasal control; -4 @300 clears box for outdoor intelligibility. Subtractive and protective, not aggressive.

Reach for the Mustard compressor + a touch of plate before adding any more EQ. If she pushes into Adele-style belts, the DEQ handles the top — resist boosting presence.

Deep-think pass — starting points reasoned from mic behavior, instrument, pop-soul genre, the artist's vocal references, and the open-air Fountain Square room on the Q225. These are informed starting points, not gospel — trust your ears at soundcheck. Band order on the 225: B4 (high) → B3 → B2 → B1 (low).